GUIDED CHILDHOOD · PRINT AT HOME

Are We Nearly There?

A screen free journey pack, and a deal for the tablet you agree before you set off.



- The journey deal card
- Car bingo for two ages
- A journey map to colour
- Games, questions, doodles
- Ages 4 to 11

Pebble and Bloop ride along. The tablet still comes, at the point you all agreed, and stars from the games add minutes to it.

FIVE MINUTES BEFORE YOU SET OFF

How to use this pack

On our long drives the tablet fight was never really about whether. It was about when. Twenty minutes in, someone asks, someone says not yet, and the next hour is a negotiation at seventy miles an hour. This pack moves that conversation to the kitchen table, before anyone is buckled in. The tablet comes at a point you all agreed. Until then there are games, and every game can add minutes to the tablet time.

THE ONE RULE

The tablet comes when the deal card says it does. Nobody has to ask, and nobody has to argue.

GET IT READY

Print the pages and clip them to a clipboard or a big hardback book. Put pencils, a couple of crayons and a sharpener in a bag. Print one bingo card for each child, and a fresh set for the way home.

AGREE THE DEAL FIRST

Fill in the deal card together before you leave. Let your child write or draw the stop where the tablet comes in. Read it back, everyone signs, and it rides in the front with the snacks.

ON THE ROAD

1. Start with the looking games: car bingo, the number plates, the alphabet. They keep eyes out of the window.
2. At the end of each game, colour the stars on the tally page. Stars earned stay earned, even if the journey gets grumpy later.
3. When the agreed point arrives, the tablet comes out with the minutes on the tally. No new conditions get added on the motorway.
4. Give a five minute warning before tablet time ends, then it goes back in the bag.

THE STAR RATE

One star is five minutes of screen time, the same rate as the Guided Childhood app. Want your own rate? Agree it and write it on the deal card.

THE DRIVER DRIVES

Spotting and writing are for passengers. The driver can still guess in twenty questions. If reading in the car makes someone feel queasy, stick to the window games.



FILL IT IN AT HOME · EVERYONE SIGNS

Our journey deal

The tablet is coming. Here is when, and how to earn more of it.

We are going to _____

Leaving on _____ Travellers _____

1 · THE TABLET COMES IN

- ☐ After the next town
- ☐ At the halfway point
- ☐ At the services
- ☐ After _____

Tablet time that is yours anyway _____ minutes

2 · STARS FROM THE GAMES ADD MINUTES

★ 1 star = _____ minutes

The app uses 5.

The most stars for this journey _____ if you want a top limit

3 · THE PROTECTED BITS, NO SCREENS AT ANY PRICE

- ☐ The first half hour. The window is the show.
- ☐ The last ten minutes. Arriving and saying hello.
- ☐ Meals at the services
- ☐ _____

Want the tablet at another time? Ask. A grown up will talk it through and say what happens next.

4 · WHEN TABLET TIME ENDS

A five minute warning. Finish the level, then it goes back in the bag.

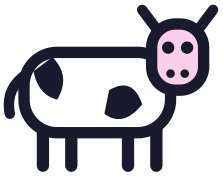
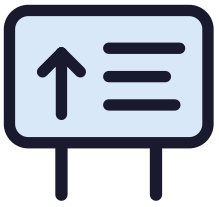
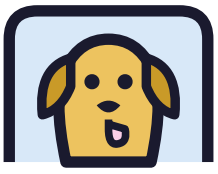
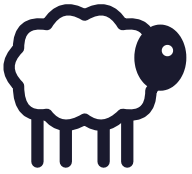
Signed _____ And _____



AGES 4 TO 7 · ONE CARD EACH

Car bingo

Spot it out of the window, then colour it in or cross it off.

 Red car	 Tractor	 Bridge	 Cow
 Petrol station	 Motorway sign	 Church spire	 Caravan
 Dog in a car	 Sheep	 Lorry	 Bus
 Bicycle	 Traffic lights	 Wind turbine	 Aeroplane



A line of four, across, down or corner to corner: shout BINGO for 1 star.
The whole card: a full house, 3 stars.



AGES 8 TO 11 · ONE CARD EACH

Car bingo, the hard card

First to spot it calls it. Cross it off, then hunt for the next one.

A red car	A tractor	A bridge over the road	A field of cows	A petrol station
A blue motorway sign	A church spire	A caravan	A dog in a car	A horse box
A wind turbine	A police car	Free space	A castle or a ruin	A roundabout with a tree on it
A tunnel	A yellow car	A car towing a boat	A motorbike	A river
A lorry from another country	A place name with a Z in it	An L plate	A postbox	A car with the roof down

A line of five, any direction, through the free star: 1 star.
Every square crossed off: a full house, 3 stars.



TWO LOOKING GAMES

The number plate game

Take the last three letters of a number plate and make a silly sentence. KDT could be Kangaroos Dance Tonight. Three sentences earn a star.

AB12 ☐☐☐	
AB12 ☐☐☐	
AB12 ☐☐☐	
AB12 ☐☐☐	
AB12 ☐☐☐	
AB12 ☐☐☐	

Younger players: hunt for a plate with the first letter of your name in it instead.

Alphabet spotting

Find something out of the window for every letter, from A to Z, and write or draw it. Older players: find the letters in order on signs and plates. A star when you reach I, another at R, and one more at Z.

A	B	C	D	E	F
G	H	I	J	K	L
M	N	O	P	Q	R
S	T	U	V	W	X
Y	Z				

Stuck on Q, X or Z? The letter can be anywhere in the word. A taXi counts.



Twenty questions

One person thinks of something. Everyone else asks questions that can only be answered yes or no. Tick a circle for each one. Guess it inside twenty to win. A round played earns a star.

THINK OF

An animal · Something in our kitchen · A character from a book · A food · A place we have been · Someone in the car

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

Would you rather

Circle your pick, then say why. Everyone answers, grown ups too. Three answers with a reason earn a star.

Have a tail	OR	Have wings	Talk to animals	OR	Speak every language
Live in a treehouse	OR	Live on a houseboat	Breakfast for tea every day	OR	Tea for breakfast every day
Be mouse sized for a day	OR	Be giraffe tall for a day	A pet dragon	OR	A pet dinosaur
Snow every Christmas	OR	Sun every birthday	Fly	OR	Breathe underwater
A car that floats	OR	A bike that flies	Invent a new sport	OR	Invent a new sweet
Sprout ice cream	OR	Chocolate covered sprouts	Swap with your teacher for a day	OR	Swap with the driver for a day

Make one up for the grown ups: _____

COLOUR AS YOU GO



Our journey map

Colour a star each time you stop or pass a big place, and draw what you saw in the box. When the tablet comes in, draw a little tablet on the road at that spot. Every stop drawn earns a star.

There!

STOP 4

STOP 3

STOP 2

STOP 1

HOME



PENCILS OUT · ANY DRAWING COUNTS

Doodles for the road

Pick any box. Scribbles, stick people and wobbly lines all count. Every two drawings earn a star.

DOODLE 1

The funniest vehicle you have seen today

DOODLE 2

Design a car for our family. What does it need?

DOODLE 3

What do you think "there" will look like? Draw it before we arrive

DOODLE 4

A cloud out of the window that looks like something else

DOODLE 5

A sign for a town that does not exist. Give it a name

DOODLE 6

The snack you are hoping for at the next stop



COUNT UP AT THE AGREED STOP

The star tally

Colour a star for each one earned. Stars earned stay earned.

Game	How the stars come	Stars
Car bingo	1 for a line, 3 for a full house	☆ ☆ ☆ ☆
Number plates	1 for every three silly sentences	☆ ☆
Alphabet spotting	1 at I, 1 at R, 1 at Z	☆ ☆ ☆
Twenty questions	1 for each round played	☆ ☆ ☆
Would you rather	1 for three answers with a reason	☆ ☆
Journey map	1 for every stop drawn	☆ ☆ ☆ ☆
Doodles	1 for every two drawings	☆ ☆ ☆

ADD IT UP

Stars _____ **× our rate** _____ **=** _____ **extra minutes**

Yours anyway _____ **+ extra** _____ **=** _____ **minutes in all**

The tablet came in at _____

The best thing we spotted _____

Spare stars? We agreed _____



Pebble says: when the five minute warning comes, finish your level, then pass the tablet to the front. Ending well is part of the deal.